Video 02 | Init (Blank) and Building Your First Sound

Massive PSXL instructional series - video script

Runtime estimate	Narration length	Scenes	Format
about 5:43 minutes	808 words at 150 words per minute	13	Screen capture of the plug-in with voice-over; dark theme, interface size 125 percent

Learning goals

- Use Load Init (Blank) and understand why the synth is silent afterwards.
- Connect nodes in the Routing tab by dragging wires, and use quick setups.
- Shape a first patch with the oscillator, filter and amp envelope.

> **NOTE.** Accuracy rule for the narrator and any generated video: use the on-screen names exactly as written in the action column. After **Load Init (Blank)** the synth is silent until routing is connected. Do not compare Massive PSXL to other products.

Scene table

Scene	On-screen action	Narration (word for word)	Visual notes and call-outs
1	Plug-in open on any factory preset, e.g. Warm Strings. Press Menu > Load Init (Blank).	Every great patch has to start somewhere. Open the Menu and choose Load Init Blank. This resets every parameter to its default, and it clears all routing, all modulation and all macro names. The preset name at the top changes to Init Blank. This is also the quickest way to get out of a mess. If a patch has become confusing, load Init Blank and start fresh; you can always press Undo or reload a preset if you change your mind.	Highlight the menu item. Show the preset name changing in the top bar.
2	Play a few notes. Nothing sounds. Open the Routing tab; the text 'No routing connections - the synth is silent.' is visible.	Now play. Nothing. That is not a bug, it is the design. In Massive PSXL nothing is connected until you connect it, and the Routing tab says so right in the middle of the screen: no routing connections, the synth is silent.	Zoom in on the on-screen message. Keep the keyboard lighting to prove notes arrive.
3	Slowly hover over the seven nodes: Osc 1, Osc 2, Noise, Filter 1, Filter 2, Insert, Out.	Here are the seven nodes. Three sources on the left, Osc 1, Osc 2 and Noise. Then Filter 1, Filter 2, the Insert, and finally Out. Signal flows from left to right, and a source can feed any node that comes later in the line. Each node has a small activity meter along its bottom edge. Once sound is flowing you will see these meters move, which is a quick way to find out where the signal is and where it stops.	Draw a faint arrow under the nodes from left to right labelled 'signal flow'.
4	Drag from the output port on the right edge of Osc 1 to the input port on the left edge of Filter 1. Then drag from Filter 1's output port to Out.	To connect two nodes, press on the circle at the right edge of the source, the output port, drag to the circle on the left edge of the target, the input port, and let go. Osc 1 to Filter 1. Then Filter 1 to Out. Notice that the ports are on the node edges. Outputs are on the right, inputs on the left, and the Out node only has an input, because it is the end of the line. You can send several sources into the same input and they are mixed together.	Highlight ports with a circle callout. While dragging, show valid input ports glowing amber.

Scene	On-screen action	Narration (word for word)	Visual notes and call-outs
5	Play a note. The wires glow and the output meters move. Hold a chord.	Play a note and there it is. The wires glow with the audio flowing through them, and the node meters and output meters move. A brighter, thicker wire means more signal. If a wire stays dark, no signal is passing, and the cause is almost always upstream. Maybe a level is at zero, or the node before it has nothing connected to it.	Slow-motion zoom on the wire with flowing dots.
6	Try an illegal connection: drag from Insert back toward Filter 1. Toast appears.	If you try to go backwards, say from the Insert back to Filter 1, you get a friendly message: signal flows left to right. The rules are simple, so it is hard to get lost.	Show the toast text clearly: 'Signal flows left to right: Insert can't feed Filter 1'.
7	Click on the wire from Osc 1 to Filter 1 (it turns white), press Delete. Then right-click empty space and show the quick setups menu; choose 'Osc 1 + Osc 2 > Filter 1 > Out'.	To remove a wire, click it, then press Delete. Or double-click it. And the right-click menu on empty space gives you quick setups: single oscillator, two oscillators, series filters, parallel filters, an insert chain, and one for drums and effects. Choose Osc 1 plus Osc 2 into Filter 1 into Out. The quick setups replace whatever routing you had, and they can be undone. They are a good way to start a patch, then adjust the wires by hand.	Pause on the quick-setup menu for 3 seconds so viewers can read every entry.
8	Right-click the Osc 2 > Filter 1 wire and choose Gain 50%. The wire shows a 50% label.	Right-click any wire to change its gain, from twenty-five to one hundred and fifty percent. That is a mixer on every connection. Let us set Osc 2 to fifty percent.	Highlight the small '50%' label on the wire.
9	Click the Osc 2 tab, set Pitch to -12. In the Osc panel switch Osc 1 to Osc 1 tab and drag Pos to 0.66.	Now shape the sound. On the Osc 2 tab, drop Pitch to minus twelve, an octave below. On Osc 1, drag Pos up to about point six six. Watch the display: the highlighted frame is a sawtooth. Pos is how you scan through the wavetable. Take a moment here and play with Pos while holding a note. This is one of the most expressive controls on the synth, and we will spend the whole next video on it.	Display zoom: show the hot line moving as Pos changes. Show the knob value tooltip as 0.66.
10	In the Filter panel set Cutoff to about 1200 Hz and Reso to 0.25 while playing.	In the Filter panel, bring Cutoff down to around twelve hundred hertz and give it a little resonance. That tames the brightness and adds focus.	Hover value readouts: Cutoff 1200 Hz, Reso 0.25.
11	Open Amp Env tab. Drag handles on the envelope display, then set Attack 0.01, Decay 0.4, Sustain 0.8, Release 0.4.	The Amp Env tab controls how each note starts and ends. Drag the handles on the graph, or use the knobs. Attack is how fast it comes in, Decay and Sustain shape the body, and Release is the tail after you let go. Try attack ten milliseconds, release point four seconds. A good rule of thumb: short attacks and releases feel percussive, long ones feel like pads. Sustain is a level, not a time, so zero means the note fades away while you hold the key.	Animate the playhead dot travelling along the envelope while a note is held.
12	Open the Verb tab in the FX panel, set Mix 0.25. Press Menu > Save preset..., show the Browse tab opening.	Add a touch of reverb from the Verb tab. Then save: Menu, Save preset opens the browser, and the Save preset button there lets you name it and choose a category. We will cover presets in the last video. For now, you have built a sound from a completely blank slate. That one added effect, a little reverb, makes a plain patch feel like a finished sound. Every effect is bypassed at a mix of zero, so you only pay for what you use.	Show the Save dialog briefly, then Cancel.
13	Close with the finished Routing tab and a short chord.	Remember the three lessons: Init Blank means silence, routing decides what you hear, and signal flows left to right. Next time we look at the oscillators and wavetables in depth.	End card: 'Next: 03 Wavetables and oscillators'.

Narration only (plain script for text-to-speech or NotebookLM)

[Scene 1] Every great patch has to start somewhere. Open the Menu and choose Load Init Blank. This resets every parameter to its default, and it clears all routing, all modulation and all macro names. The preset name at the top changes to Init Blank. This is also the quickest way to get out of a mess. If a patch has become confusing, load Init Blank and start fresh; you can always press Undo or reload a preset if you change your mind.

[Scene 2] Now play. Nothing. That is not a bug, it is the design. In Massive PSXL nothing is connected until you connect it, and the Routing tab says so right in the middle of the screen: no routing connections, the synth is silent.

[Scene 3] Here are the seven nodes. Three sources on the left, Osc 1, Osc 2 and Noise. Then Filter 1, Filter 2, the Insert, and finally Out. Signal flows from left to right, and a source can feed any node that comes later in the line. Each node has a small activity meter along its bottom edge. Once sound is flowing you will see these meters move, which is a quick way to find out where the signal is and where it stops.

[Scene 4] To connect two nodes, press on the circle at the right edge of the source, the output port, drag to the circle on the left edge of the target, the input port, and let go. Osc 1 to Filter 1. Then Filter 1 to Out. Notice that the ports are on the node edges. Outputs are on the right, inputs on the left, and the Out node only has an input, because it is the end of the line. You can send several sources into the same input and they are mixed together.

[Scene 5] Play a note and there it is. The wires glow with the audio flowing through them, and the node meters and output meters move. A brighter, thicker wire means more signal. If a wire stays dark, no signal is passing, and the cause is almost always upstream. Maybe a level is at zero, or the node before it has nothing connected to it.

[Scene 6] If you try to go backwards, say from the Insert back to Filter 1, you get a friendly message: signal flows left to right. The rules are simple, so it is hard to get lost.

[Scene 7] To remove a wire, click it, then press Delete. Or double-click it. And the right-click menu on empty space gives you quick setups: single oscillator, two oscillators, series filters, parallel filters, an insert chain, and one for drums and effects. Choose Osc 1 plus Osc 2 into Filter 1 into Out. The quick setups replace whatever routing you had, and they can be undone. They are a good way to start a patch, then adjust the wires by hand.

[Scene 8] Right-click any wire to change its gain, from twenty-five to one hundred and fifty percent. That is a mixer on every connection. Let us set Osc 2 to fifty percent.

[Scene 9] Now shape the sound. On the Osc 2 tab, drop Pitch to minus twelve, an octave below. On Osc 1, drag Pos up to about point six six. Watch the display: the highlighted frame is a sawtooth. Pos is how you scan through the wavetable. Take a moment here and play with Pos while holding a note. This is one of the most expressive controls on the synth, and we will spend the whole next video on it.

[Scene 10] In the Filter panel, bring Cutoff down to around twelve hundred hertz and give it a little resonance. That tames the brightness and adds focus.

[Scene 11] The Amp Env tab controls how each note starts and ends. Drag the handles on the graph, or use the knobs. Attack is how fast it comes in, Decay and Sustain shape the body, and Release is the tail after you let go. Try attack ten milliseconds, release point four seconds. A good rule of thumb: short attacks and

releases feel percussive, long ones feel like pads. Sustain is a level, not a time, so zero means the note fades away while you hold the key.

[Scene 12] Add a touch of reverb from the Verb tab. Then save: Menu, Save preset opens the browser, and the Save preset button there lets you name it and choose a category. We will cover presets in the last video. For now, you have built a sound from a completely blank slate. That one added effect, a little reverb, makes a plain patch feel like a finished sound. Every effect is bypassed at a mix of zero, so you only pay for what you use.

[Scene 13] Remember the three lessons: Init Blank means silence, routing decides what you hear, and signal flows left to right. Next time we look at the oscillators and wavetables in depth.

> **TIP.** Pause for about one second between scenes and let on-screen actions finish before the next sentence starts.